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GO BIG

50% Share of biofuels in the transportation sector by 2030

27% Target for ethanol blending in petrol by 2030

Shift towards non-food biomass ethanol expected

Automakers to expedite flex fuel vehicle production

28% GST on flex fuel vehicles; this needs to be cut

oil marketing companies (OMCs) are absorbing a ₹1.7 per litre loss on E20, citing high feedstock costs. While automakers insist that no engine damage has been reported, some insurers have warned that using ethanol-blended fuel in non-compatible vehicles may void engine-related claims.

This brings us to the larger question of whether India's ethanol policy, as it stands now, requires a re-examination.

GLOBAL LESSONS

Petrol with 20% ethanol is called E20. In Brazil, which pioneered E27 decades ago, ethanol-blended fuel is cheaper than petrol. The price of ethanol-

▲ Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched E20 fuel at the Green Mobility Rally during the India Energy Week in 2023